



UAE, BRAZIL PRESIDENTS DISCUSS ECONOMIC COOPERATION

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan meets Luiz Inacio Lula da Silva, President of Brazil, at the Presidential Airport. The meeting addressed the ongoing negotiations between the UAE and the Southern Common Market (Mercosur) to establish a Comprehensive Economic Partnership, which have reached their final stage, among the several issues that were discussed. The two sides expressed their hope that, once concluded, the partnership would create further opportunities for constructive economic cooperation between the UAE and Brazil.

New UK rules kick in, complicating travel for British dual nationals in UAE

Airlines told to block UK citizens without British passports as ETA checks begin

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

British citizens who also hold another nationality could be stopped from travelling to the UK under new border rules linked to the rollout of the country's electronic travel authorisation (ETA) system, complicating travel for British dual nationals in the UAE.

Under the changes implemented yesterday, dual British nationals must present either a valid British passport or a foreign passport endorsed with a certificate of entitlement to enter the UK. Those who fail to do so may be refused boarding by airlines, ferry operators or rail companies before they reach the border.

"The correct permission for British citizens is a British passport or a foreign passport endorsed with a certificate of entitlement," a Home Office said in a statement. "At their own discretion, carriers may accept some expired British passports as alternative documentation."

Dh79
Cost of ETA that travellers who previously entered the UK without a visa must hold

The British Embassy in the UAE said the changes are part of a wider move to digitise the UK's immigration system. "We are making improvements to deliver a more streamlined, digital immigration system which will be quicker and more secure for the millions of people who pass through the UK border each year," it said in a separate statement.

Starting yesterday, travellers who previously entered the UK without a visa must hold an ETA costing £16 (Dh79). Airlines can refuse boarding to passengers who do not have one. ETAs are also required for passengers transiting through the UK, unless they remain airside and do not pass through border control.

British and Irish citizens do not need an ETA. Dual British nationals are not eligible to apply for one under the rules.

Iran slams US missile claims as 'big lies'

PRESIDENT SEES 'FAVOURABLE OUTLOOK' ON EVE OF GENEVA TALKS

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Iran yesterday dismissed US accusations about its missile programme as "big lies," even as President Masoud Pezeshkian voiced cautious optimism ahead of a fresh round of negotiations with Washington.

Foreign ministry spokesman Esmail Baqaei rejected claims by US President Donald Trump that Tehran was developing missiles capable of striking the United States.

"Whatever they're alleging in regards to Iran's nuclear programme, Iran's ballistic missiles, and the number of casualties during January's unrest, is simply the repetition of 'big lies'," Baqaei said in a post on X.

Although Baqaei did not specify which remarks he was directly addressing, Trump had hours earlier warned that Iran was seeking missile capabilities that could reach American soil.

Lacking the ability

In a recent interview with Al Jazeera, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said Tehran lacked the ability to target the US mainland but cautioned that Iran would retaliate against American bases in the Middle East if attacked.

Trump, meanwhile, reiterated in his annual State of the Union speech that Iran would never

Foreign ministry spokesman Esmail Baqaei rejected claims by Donald Trump that Tehran was developing missiles capable of striking the US.

be allowed to develop a nuclear weapon, accusing its leadership of pursuing "sinister nuclear ambitions." Tehran has consistently denied seeking a bomb.

The US president also claimed that Iranian authorities killed 32,000 people during protests earlier this year. Iranian officials have acknowledged more than 3,000 deaths. Independent estimates from the US-based Human Rights Activists News Agency (HRANA) place the toll above 7,000.

The sharp rhetoric comes as Tehran and Washington prepare for a third round of Oman-mediated talks in Geneva today.

Despite the tensions, President Pezeshkian struck a more hopeful tone. "We see a favourable outlook for the negotiations," he said in remarks carried by state media.

Foreign Minister Araghchi and his delegation left Tehran for Geneva yesterday. He said earlier this week that a deal was "within reach, but only if diplomacy is given priority."

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PRAYER
TIMINGS

IFTAR 18:22

Fajr	05:27	Shuruq	06:41
Dhuhur	12:35	Asr	15:52
Maghrib	18:22	Isha	19:36

IMSAK 05:17

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah

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RAK aims to triple tourists and double hotels by 2030

RAK tourism's new CEO Phillippa Harrison still wants to retain emirate's soul

DUBAI
BY DHANUSHA GOKULAN
Chief Reporter

Phillippa Harrison, the new CEO of the Ras Al Khaimah Tourism Development Authority (RAKTDA) arrived from Australia just five months ago. She had been running tourism there for six years when, as she puts it, "the usual way — you get a phone call out of the blue" — brought her to the UAE.

What she found surprised her. "I was so blown away," she says. "I was blown away by a couple of things. One about the beauty of the emirate."

Now, at a time when Ras Al Khaimah is preparing for rapid expansion, her ambition is clear: to ensure the world not only knows about the emir-



ate but understands it. "I want to make sure that the world knows about Ras Al Khaimah and they know what a special place it is to visit. We're going to double the hotel keys in the emirate in the next three years. We're going to triple our visitation by 2030," she added.

Rapid expansion can, however, dilute a destination's soul. Phillippa is acutely aware of this. "The way that you manage that is through very thoughtful planning." Even when the emirate doubles in size, she says, "we're still going to be small and boutique."

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